

AIEC Global — Nepal-Specific Study Abroad FAQ

Covers Nepal government clearance (NOC), Nepal Rastra Bank forex rules, and document authentication for Nepali students studying abroad. Figures such as forex caps change periodically via NRB circular — confirm current limits with your bank before relying on a specific number.

1. What is a No Objection Certificate (NOC) and do I need one to study abroad from Nepal?

The NOC is a mandatory clearance letter issued by Nepal's Ministry of Education, Science and Technology (MoEST) confirming the Government of Nepal has no objection to a student studying overseas. Any Nepali citizen going abroad for full-time formal study lasting more than 3 months needs one — without it you cannot legally buy foreign exchange from a Nepali bank for tuition or living costs, and immigration at Tribhuvan International Airport can flag its absence. This is specific to Nepal's own outbound-student clearance system and is unrelated to "NOC" concepts used for other purposes in other countries.

(<https://www.aeccglobal.com/np/advice/noc-no-objection-certificate-for-nepalese-students>)

2. How and where do I apply for the NOC, and what documents do I need?

As of 2026 the process is fully online through the official portal noc.moest.gov.np, run by MoEST's Foreign Study Section, with no in-person visit required. Typical processing takes about 3-7 working days once documents are submitted correctly, and required documents include your citizenship certificate, passport, academic transcripts, migration certificate, the university offer/admission letter, and an equivalence certificate where applicable. Attending a pre-departure orientation session is also part of getting the NOC issued.

(<https://www.aeccglobal.com/np/advice/noc-no-objection-certificate-for-nepalese-students>)

3. Do I need to attend a pre-departure orientation before flying out for studies?

Yes — Nepal's government requires a Pre-Departure Orientation (PDO) as part of the NOC process, sponsored/regulated by MoEST and typically delivered by registered educational consultancies or approved providers. It covers practical topics like visa rules, banking, living costs, cultural adjustment and safety abroad; skipping it can delay your NOC issuance since it is treated as a prerequisite rather than an optional extra.

(<https://bhasika.com/blogs/pre-departure-orientation-guide-for-nepali-students-162>)

4. Does Nepal Rastra Bank (NRB) require a separate forex permit to send tuition money abroad, and how does that work?

Once you hold a valid NOC, Nepali banks are authorized to release foreign exchange for education without you needing a further separate NRB permit — the NOC itself functions as the enabling clearance for tuition remittance. Reported limits: students can convert up to roughly USD 12,000 per academic year through the banking system for education, with a further ~USD 2,500 sometimes cited for the visa-application stage; banks also charge a 3% education service fee on the forex purchased, refundable if the visa is refused. NRB circulars are updated periodically, so treat exact dollar figures as indicative rather than fixed — confirm current caps with the disbursing bank before transferring funds. (<https://pioneerlaw.com/nrb-circular-on-foreign-exchange-facility-to-nepalese-students/>)

5. How much cash or foreign currency can I personally carry out of Nepal for my studies?

For general travelers, NRB currently allows carrying up to about USD 3,000 in foreign currency

without special permit, and amounts above USD 5,000 must be declared at customs regardless of purpose. For students specifically, reporting varies by source — some cite a cash-carry allowance around USD 500 for living expenses with the remainder required to move through banking channels, while overall annual education-related forex facilitated through banks has been cited as high as USD 12,000-25,000 depending on the case. Verify the current exact cap directly with your bank or NRB before relying on a specific number. (<https://www.fiscalnepal.com/2025/07/11/21283/nrb-increases-foreign-travel-currency-limit-to-3000-for-nepali-citizens/>)

6. What academic documents from my Nepali college do I need before applying abroad, besides the NOC?

You'll typically need an official transcript, your degree/provisional certificate, and — if you attended a constituent/affiliated campus — a Migration Certificate transferring your academic record, which costs roughly NPR 1,000-1,100 and is issued only once. These are distinct from the MoEST-issued NOC: the NOC is a government travel/forex clearance, while transcripts and migration certificates are your academic institution's own records verifying your qualifications to the foreign university and immigration authorities. (<https://studyabroadfromnepal.com/resources/transcript-certificate>)

7. Do my Nepali documents need to be apostilled or notarized for a foreign student visa, and how does that work since Nepal isn't part of the Hague Apostille Convention?

Nepal is not a signatory to the Hague Apostille Convention, so there is no true "apostille" available for Nepali-issued documents. Instead, the standard path is: get the document certified by the issuing institution or a notary, then have it authenticated by the Department of Consular Services at Nepal's Ministry of Foreign Affairs (MoFA) — this MoFA attestation is Nepal's practical equivalent to an apostille. Most major destination countries (Australia, UK, Canada, USA) only require a certified translation for the visa application itself, not full MoFA/embassy attestation — requirements vary by country and by whether the document is going to the university or the visa office, so always confirm with the specific embassy or high commission.

(<https://notarynepal.com/services/apostille-of-documents-in-nepal>)